TGS-2024043854 · DAY 1 · LAB 1 · 55 MIN

Hire Your First AI Employee — Customer & Market Research Brief

Build a Human-AI Workforce with Autonomous AI Agents · Single agent · LO1

> Install Hermes, give it company context and long-term memory, and let one agent turn raw reviews and live web research into a brief you can act on.

The business scenario

You are Kopi Kaki Co.'s Marketing Lead. The Gula Melaka Cold Brew launches on 1 Dec and you have 60 unread customer reviews, a competitor list and no analyst. You 'hire' Mia — a Hermes Agent marketing analyst — onboard her with the company context, and ask for a research brief that tells you which campaign angle to run.

You will deliver

- outputs/lab01/review-insights.md — ratings, themes and evidence (review IDs)
- outputs/lab01/research-brief.md — trends, competitors, 3 campaign angles with evidence
- Mia's long-term memory holds the brand facts and YOUR chosen angle (recalled in a new session)

Agents: 1 Hermes agent — 'Mia', AI marketing analyst
You (the human): Set the goal, challenge the evidence, choose the campaign angle
Goal: Install and configure an autonomous LLM agent, give it context and long-term memory, and analyse its perception → reasoning → action loop on a real research task (LO1).

Before you start

- A laptop (macOS, Linux or Windows with WSL2) with admin rights and internet access
- An LLM provider sign-in or API key (Nous Portal, OpenRouter, OpenAI/Codex, Anthropic)
- This lab folder downloaded (course repo → Code → Download ZIP)

Lab files (data/)

File	What it is
`AGENTS.md`	Company context Hermes loads automatically
`brand-guide.md`	Brand voice, colours, platform formats
`campaign-brief.md`	Gula Melaka Cold Brew campaign brief (offer, KPIs, timeline)

`compliance-rules.md`	C1–C10 brand-safety and escalation rules
`product-catalogue.csv`	12 products and prices
`customer-reviews.csv`	60 synthetic customer reviews
`competitors.csv`	6 fictional competitors
`assets/brand-palette.png`	Brand image asset
`assets/cold-brew-product-card.png`	Brand image asset
`assets/kopi-kaki-logo.png`	Brand image asset

All company data in this lab (Kopi Kaki Co., people, reviews, comments, metrics, competitors) is fictional and generated for training.

Steps

1. Install Hermes Agent (skip if your trainer pre-installed it)

macOS / Linux / WSL2 — run the one-line installer in Terminal. Windows — use the PowerShell installer (or install inside WSL2). The installer sets up Python, Node.js, ripgrep and ffmpeg for you.

TERMINAL

```
curl -fsSL https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/install.sh | bash
# Windows PowerShell:  iex (irm https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/install.ps1)
source ~/.zshrc    # or ~/.bashrc — puts 'hermes' on your PATH
```

✓ Expected: `hermes --version` prints a version number.

2. Connect a model and check health

Run the setup wizard and choose a provider (Nous Portal, OpenRouter, OpenAI/Codex, Anthropic …). Pick a model with a context window of at least 64,000 tokens. Then run the doctor.

TERMINAL

```
hermes setup
hermes doctor
```

✓ Expected: `hermes doctor` shows green checks for the model and tools.

3. Create the Kopi Kaki workspace and add the lab data

Download this lab's folder (or the whole course repo) and copy everything in `data/` into a new folder `~/kopi-kaki`. Hermes automatically loads `AGENTS.md` from the folder you start it in — that is how Mia learns who the company is.

TERMINAL

```
mkdir -p ~/kopi-kaki/outputs/lab01
cp -R data/* ~/kopi-kaki/
cd ~/kopi-kaki
hermes
```

✓ Expected: The Hermes chat opens. Type `/help` to see slash commands.

4. Onboard Mia — persona and long-term memory

PROMPT — PASTE INTO HERMES CHAT (STARTED INSIDE ~/KOPI-KAKI)

```
You are Mia, Kopi Kaki Co.'s AI marketing analyst. Read AGENTS.md, brand-guide.md and campaign-
brief.md in this folder.

Save these facts to your long-term memory:
- Kopi Kaki Co.: Singapore kopi chain, 12 outlets, positioning "Heritage kopi, modern craft".
- Launch: Gula Melaka Cold Brew, SGD 6.80, launches 1 Dec 2026, campaign #ShiokColdBrew 17 Nov -
14 Dec.
- Promo SHIOK20: 20% off the first Gula Melaka Cold Brew ordered in the app, valid 1-14 Dec 2026,
one per customer.
- Never publish anything without my APPROVE. Never make health or halal claims.

Then summarise the company in 5 bullets and ask me the 3 questions a new analyst should ask on day
one.
```

✓ Expected: Mia confirms the memory was saved and returns 5 bullets + 3 questions. Check the file itself: `cat ~/.hermes/memories/MEMORY.md` shows the facts.

5. Perceive the data — analyse 60 customer reviews

PROMPT — PASTE INTO HERMES CHAT

```
Analyse customer-reviews.csv.
1. Rating distribution (count and % for 1-5 stars) and average rating per outlet.
2. The top 5 praise themes and top 5 complaint themes, each with a count and 2 example review_ids.
3. Anything relevant to a cold-brew launch (mentions of cold brew, sweetness, oat milk, app).
Show your calculation method. Save the result as outputs/lab01/review-insights.md.
```

✓ Expected: A Markdown report with a ratings table and themes that cite review IDs (e.g. R1012).

6. Perceive the world — live web research

PROMPT — PASTE INTO HERMES CHAT

```
Use web search to research specialty coffee and cold-brew trends in Singapore in 2026 (consumer preferences, price points, social media formats that work). Combine this with competitors.csv (the competitors are fictional - treat them as our internal notes).
Rules: cite every web fact with its URL; mark anything you could not verify as UNVERIFIED; do not invent statistics.
```

✓ Expected: 5+ cited findings with URLs and a competitor comparison table.

7. Act — write the research brief

PROMPT — PASTE INTO HERMES CHAT

```
Write outputs/lab01/research-brief.md for the Marketing Lead with:
1. Executive summary (5 lines).
2. What our customers say (from review-insights.md).
3. Market & competitor snapshot (cited).
4. Three campaign angles for #ShiokColdBrew. For each: the big idea, target audience, supporting evidence (review IDs or URLs), the KPI it drives, and one risk.
5. A final section "Decision needed" asking me to choose one angle.
Follow the brand guide and compliance rules.
```

✓ Expected: research-brief.md with three evidence-backed angles and a 'Decision needed' section.

8. Human checkpoint — challenge, then decide

Read the brief like a manager. Challenge at least one claim, then make the decision and tell Mia to remember it.

PROMPT — PASTE INTO HERMES CHAT

```
Which review_ids support angle 2? Quote them. Then: I choose angle <1|2|3> because <your reason>. Save my decision and reason to long-term memory, and add a "Decision log" section to research-brief.md.
```

✓ Expected: Mia quotes the supporting reviews, updates the brief and confirms the memory write.

9. Test long-term memory in a brand-new session

First confirm the decision is in the memory file. Then exit with `/exit`, start a fresh session and ask Mia what she remembers. A new session has an empty short-term memory; memory files load at session start, so the answer should come from MEMORY.md (ask her where it came from — 'I'll remember' in a chat is not proof).

TERMINAL

```
cat ~/.hermes/memories/MEMORY.md
hermes
```

PROMPT — PASTE INTO NEW HERMES CHAT

```
Which campaign angle did I choose, and why? What is the promo code and its terms? Tell me whether you got this from your memory file or by searching past sessions.
```

✓ Expected: Mia answers correctly without re-reading the files.

Verification / checkpoint

- □ outputs/lab01/review-insights.md and research-brief.md exist and cite review IDs / URLs
- □ The brief ends with a decision log naming the angle you chose
- □ MEMORY.md contains the brand facts and your decision
- □ A new session recalls the chosen angle and the SHIOK20 terms
- □ PP evidence: take ONE screenshot now of the research brief or the memory recall — Task 1 of the Practical Performance uses it

Checkpoint: Every insight cites review IDs or a URL; the angle you chose is recalled in a brand-new session.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Fix
`hermes: command not found`	Open a new terminal or run `source ~/.zshrc` (macOS) / `source ~/.bashrc` (Linux/WSL2).
Model errors / context too small	Re-run `hermes setup` (or `hermes model`) and choose a model with ≥ 64k context.
Web search not available	Run `hermes tools` and enable the web toolset. Keyless search works for light use; for reliability add a free key, e.g. `hermes config set TAVILY_API_KEY tvly-...` (you reuse it on Day 2).
Windows paths	On native Windows Hermes keeps its data in %LOCALAPPDATA%\hermes instead of ~/.hermes — or run the labs inside WSL2.
Mia ignores the brand rules	Make sure you started `hermes` inside ~/kopi-kaki so AGENTS.md is loaded.

Stretch challenge

Ask Mia: "Save the review-analysis procedure you just used as a reusable skill called review-insights." Then run `hermes skills list` — a self-improving agent turns experience into procedural memory.

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